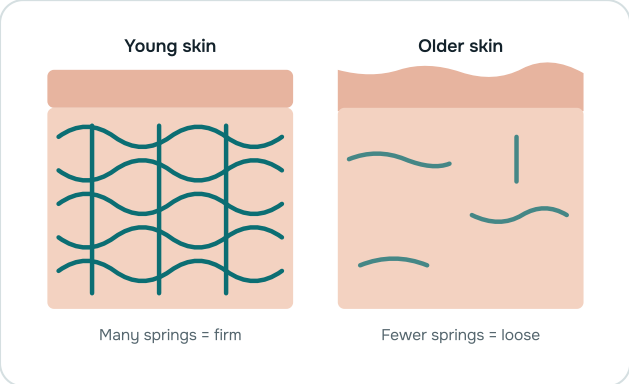
Which collagen stick is best?

	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
									
	YOROSUM Glow Peptide	HURUM Small Molecular Fish Collagen	MIPPEUM Collagen Jelly Mix Package	SSF Real Pomegranate Collagen Jelly	BB LAB Goodnight Collagen	BOTO Glutathione White Collagen	BB LAB Collagen Biotin Plus	HURUM Biotin Collagen Peptide	VITASUB Slim Collagen Plus
Score out of 10, higher is better	**8.4**/10 EXCELLENT	**7.2**/10 VERY GOOD	**5.0**/10 WEAK	**4.9**/10 WEAK	**4.8**/10 WEAK	**4.6**/10 WEAK	**4.2**/10 WEAK	**4.0**/10 WEAK	**1.3**/10 AVOID
Collagen per stick more is better	2,000 mg	1,200 mg	1,600 mg	1,000 mg	1,200 mg	800 mg	1,200 mg	500 mg	196 mg
Piece size (Da) smaller is better	300 Da	300 Da	Under 600 Da	300 Da	1,000 Da	2,000 Da	1,000 Da	Not on box	Not on box
Vitamin C per stick 100 mg is ideal	100 mg	120 mg	None listed	4 mg	30 mg	220 mg	30 mg	120 mg	200 µg
Clean formula no useless extras	Good	Some filler	Some filler	Some filler	Good	Tiny extras	Tiny extras	Tiny extras	Tiny extras
In one box sticks × weight	30 sticks × 3 g	60 sticks × 2 g	45 sticks × 20 g	100 sticks × 20 g	50 sticks × 2 g	30 sticks × 4 g	50 sticks × 2 g	90 sticks × 2 g	30 sticks × 2 g

What is collagen, and why do people take it?

Before you compare products, it helps to know what collagen is, what it does in the body and what a collagen stick is.



1. **It is a protein**
   Collagen is the most common protein in the human body. It forms long, strong threads that hold skin, bones, joints, hair and nails together.
2. **It keeps skin firm**
   In the skin, collagen threads work like the springs in a mattress. They keep skin firm, smooth and able to spring back.
3. **The body makes less with age**
   From our mid-20s, the body makes a little less collagen each year. Sun, smoking, stress and poor sleep speed this up. Skin becomes thinner and drier, and lines appear.
4. **What a collagen stick is**
   A stick is a small packet with one daily serving. You mix the powder with water, or eat the jelly straight from the stick. Inside is collagen that has been cut into small pieces, called collagen peptides.
5. **How it works**
   The body absorbs the small pieces into the blood. Studies suggest some of them act as a signal that tells skin cells to make more of their own collagen. In studies, people took collagen every day for 8 to 12 weeks before results were measured.

There are different types of collagen. For skin, Type I matters most.

Type I

Skin, hair, nails and bones. About 90% of all collagen in the body. Comes from **fish** or cows. Fish collagen is mostly Type I and contains no pork or beef.

Type II

Joints and cartilage. Usually made from chicken. Used in joint products, not in skin products.

Type III

Skin and blood vessels. Works together with Type I. Usually made from cows or pigs.

What does "Da" mean, and why is smaller better?

Natural collagen is a huge molecule. The body cannot absorb it whole, so makers cut it into small pieces. The Da number on the box tells you how small those pieces are.

1 Da is a unit of weight for molecules

Da is short for dalton. Scientists use it to weigh molecules, which are far too small to see. One dalton is about the weight of one hydrogen atom, the lightest atom there is. A bigger Da number means a bigger piece.

2 Collagen is a chain of beads

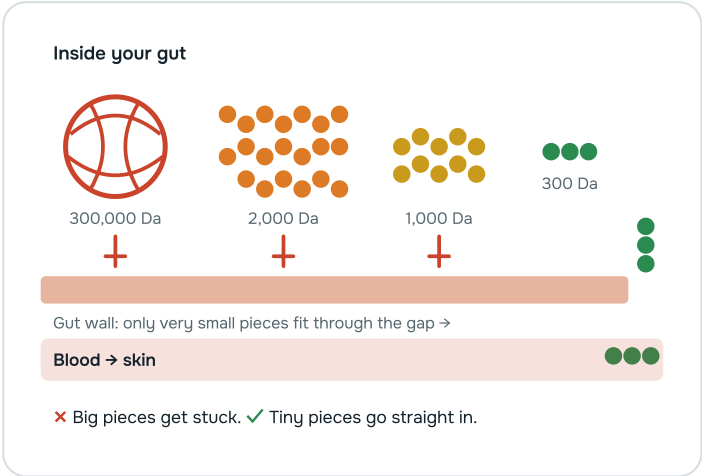
Collagen is built from small building blocks called amino acids. Picture a very long necklace: each bead is one amino acid and weighs about 100 Da. Natural collagen has about 3,000 beads, so it weighs about 300,000 Da. Makers use enzymes to cut this necklace into short pieces.

3 The gut lets only small pieces through

The wall of the gut works like a fine sieve. Pieces of 2 or 3 beads (about 200–400 Da) pass through easily, carried by special transporters. Longer pieces must first be broken down further during digestion before the body can use them.

4 The number on the box is an average

A box that says 300 Da means the pieces weigh 300 Da on average: most are tiny, a few are bigger. A lower average means more of the collagen is already small enough to absorb.



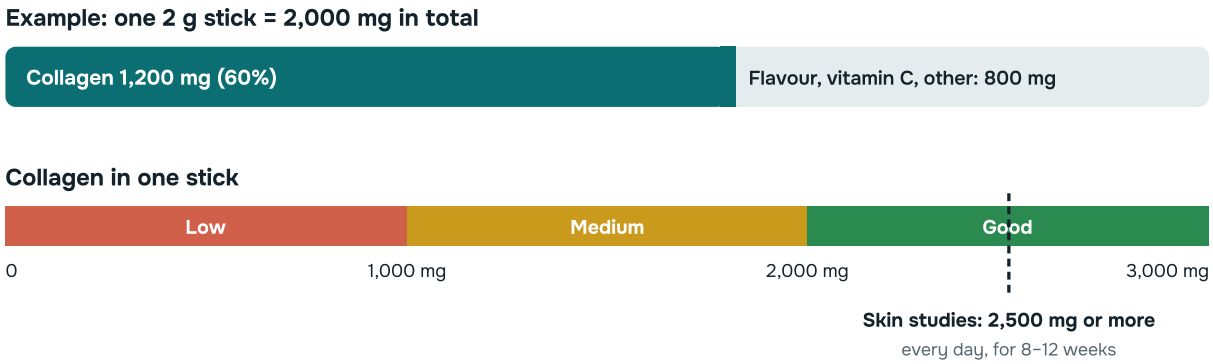


REMEMBER

Look for 평균분자량 (average molecular weight) on the box. 300 Da or lower is the best you can buy.

How much collagen is in one stick?

Small pieces help the body absorb collagen. But the amount matters just as much: a stick with tiny pieces and very little collagen cannot do much.



1. **mg and g**
   mg means milligram. 1,000 mg = 1 g. Stick weight is usually shown in grams, and ingredients in milligrams.

2. **Not the whole stick is collagen**
   A 2 g stick weighs 2,000 mg, but part of it is flavour, vitamin C and other ingredients. Only the collagen part counts. That is why two sticks of the same weight can hold very different amounts of collagen.

3. **How to find the amount on the box**
   Look for the collagen amount per stick (1포당). If the box shows only a percentage, multiply: stick weight in mg × collagen % = collagen in mg. Example: 2,000 mg × 60% = 1,200 mg. Some boxes print the total for the whole box, so check that the number is for one stick.

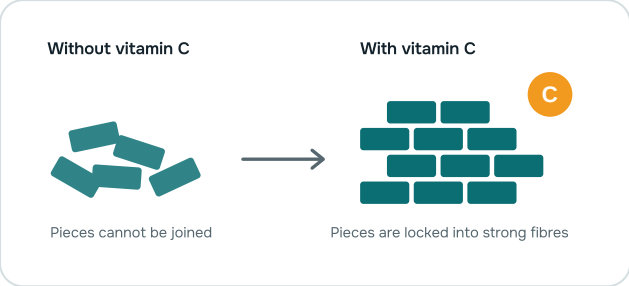
4. **How much is enough**
   In skin studies, people took 2,500 mg to 10,000 mg of collagen every day. Under 1,000 mg per stick is low. 1,000–2,000 mg is medium. 2,000 mg or more is good.

REMEMBER

Choose at least 1,000 mg of collagen per stick. 2,000 mg or more is better.

Why vitamin C matters for collagen

Vitamin C does not turn into collagen. But the body cannot build collagen without it. That is why good collagen sticks include it.



1 Skin cells build collagen

Special skin cells make new collagen fibres. They use amino acids from food and from collagen supplements as building blocks, like bricks.

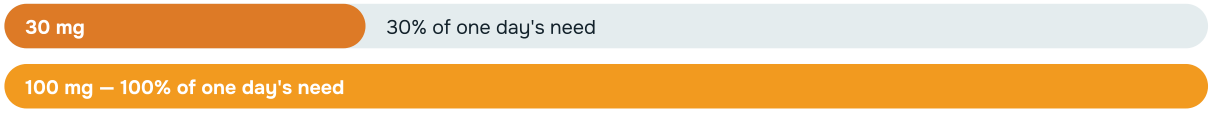
2 Vitamin C is the builder's tool

To join the chains into a strong, stable fibre, these cells use two enzymes, and both need vitamin C to work. Without it, the new collagen is weak and falls apart. This is why people with a severe lack of vitamin C (scurvy) get bleeding gums and wounds that do not heal.

3 The body cannot store it

The human body cannot make vitamin C and stores very little of it. We need a fresh supply every day from food or supplements.

How much of one day's vitamin C need does a stick cover?



Daily need: Korea 100 mg, USA 90 mg, Europe 80 mg.

4 How much to look for

Korea sets the daily need for vitamin C at 100 mg. A stick with about 100 mg covers the full day. A stick with 30 mg covers less than a third. If vitamin C is not listed on the box, assume there is none.

5 What vitamin C does not do

Vitamin C does not help collagen get into the blood. Its job starts later, inside the skin, where it helps build new collagen. More than 100 mg is fine, but it does not raise the score in our ranking.

REMEMBER

Look for about 100 mg of vitamin C in each stick.

Extra ingredients: is there enough to matter?

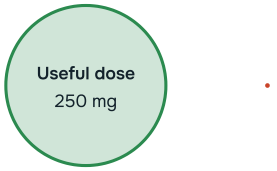
Many boxes advertise extra ingredients in big letters, such as glutathione, biotin or hyaluronic acid. An ingredient can only help if there is enough of it. Below, the green circle shows the amount used in studies, and the red dot shows how much is in one stick.



Glutathione

VITASUB Slim Collagen Plus

An antioxidant that boxes often link to "whitening" or brighter skin. Studies that gave it by mouth used 250–1,000 mg a day.



1,250 sticks

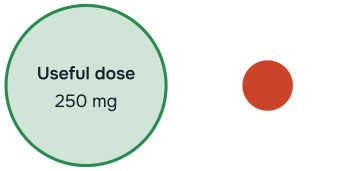
You would need to take this many sticks a day to reach the amount used in studies.



Glutathione

BOTO Glutathione White Collagen

An antioxidant that boxes often link to "whitening" or brighter skin. Studies that gave it by mouth used 250–1,000 mg a day.



10 sticks

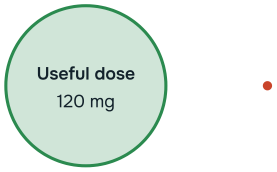
You would need to take this many sticks a day to reach the amount used in studies.



Hyaluronic acid

HURUM Small Molecular Fish Collagen

A substance that holds water in the skin. Studies that gave it by mouth used about 120–240 mg a day.



300 sticks

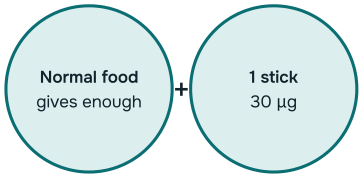
You would need to take this many sticks a day to reach the amount used in studies.



Biotin

BB LAB Collagen Biotin Plus, HURUM Biotin Collagen Peptide

A B vitamin (vitamin B7). An adult needs about 30 µg a day. µg means microgram: 1 mg = 1,000 µg.



No extra effect

One stick gives a full day of biotin, but normal food already gives enough. Extra biotin does not improve skin or hair in people who are not lacking it.

REMEMBER

A famous ingredient name is not a sign of quality. Check the amount in mg and compare it with the amount used in studies.

6 questions to ask before you buy

Use these questions for any collagen product, including ones not in this guide.

Is it fish collagen?

Fish collagen is mostly Type I, the type found in skin. It contains no pork or beef.

Is the Da printed on the box, and is it 300 Da or lower?

Smaller pieces are absorbed more easily. If the box does not show Da, ask the seller.

Is there at least 1,000 mg of collagen in one stick?

2,000 mg or more is better. Skin studies used 2,500 mg or more a day.

Is there about 100 mg of vitamin C in one stick?

The body needs vitamin C to build collagen. 100 mg covers one full day.

Are the extra ingredients there in useful amounts?

Check the mg. A famous name in a tiny amount does nothing.

Are the amounts shown for one stick?

Some boxes show the total for the whole box. Always compare one stick with one stick.

Scores are based on the amounts printed on each product's label or seller listing. This guide compares product labels to help with buying decisions. It is not medical advice.